

The origin of psychology

Course instructor:
Shweta Chawak
IIT Bombay
Humanities and Social Sciences

RECAP!

- Psychology
 - Greek word: psyche = mind
 - Logos = knowledge or study
- Scientific study of behaviour and mental processes
 - Overt and Covert behaviour
- Study of ABC: Affect, Behaviour, and Cognition
- Not common sense:
 - Focuses on evidence
 - Systematic and intersubjective

***Long Time Ago... In Galaxy not so
far away!
Long before Psychology became
Science, humans were trying to
understand
How are mind body connected?***



In the Beginning!

- Aristotle: soul is related to the body
- Plato and Rene Descartes: soul is separate from the body known as the dualism
- Philosophers: human mind and its connection to the physical body
- Physicians and physiologists: physical connection between the body and the brain

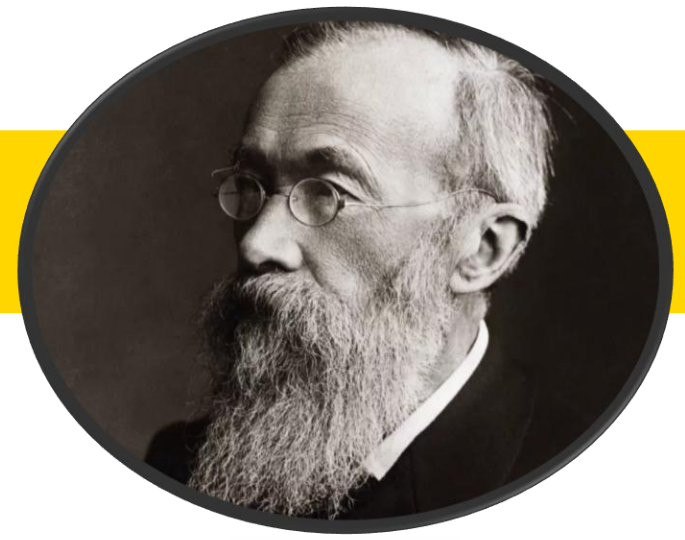


First question people ask when you say you study
Psychology....

Are you analysing me?

Do you know what I am thinking right now?

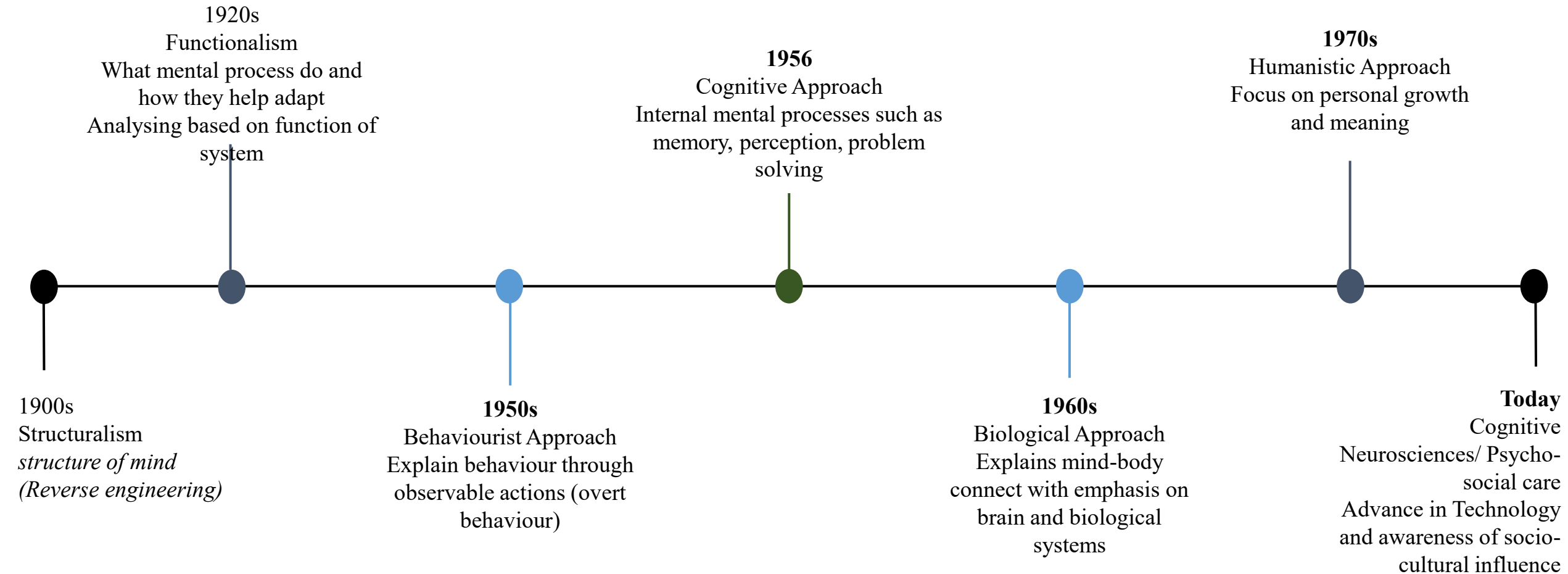
Birth of Scientific Psychology



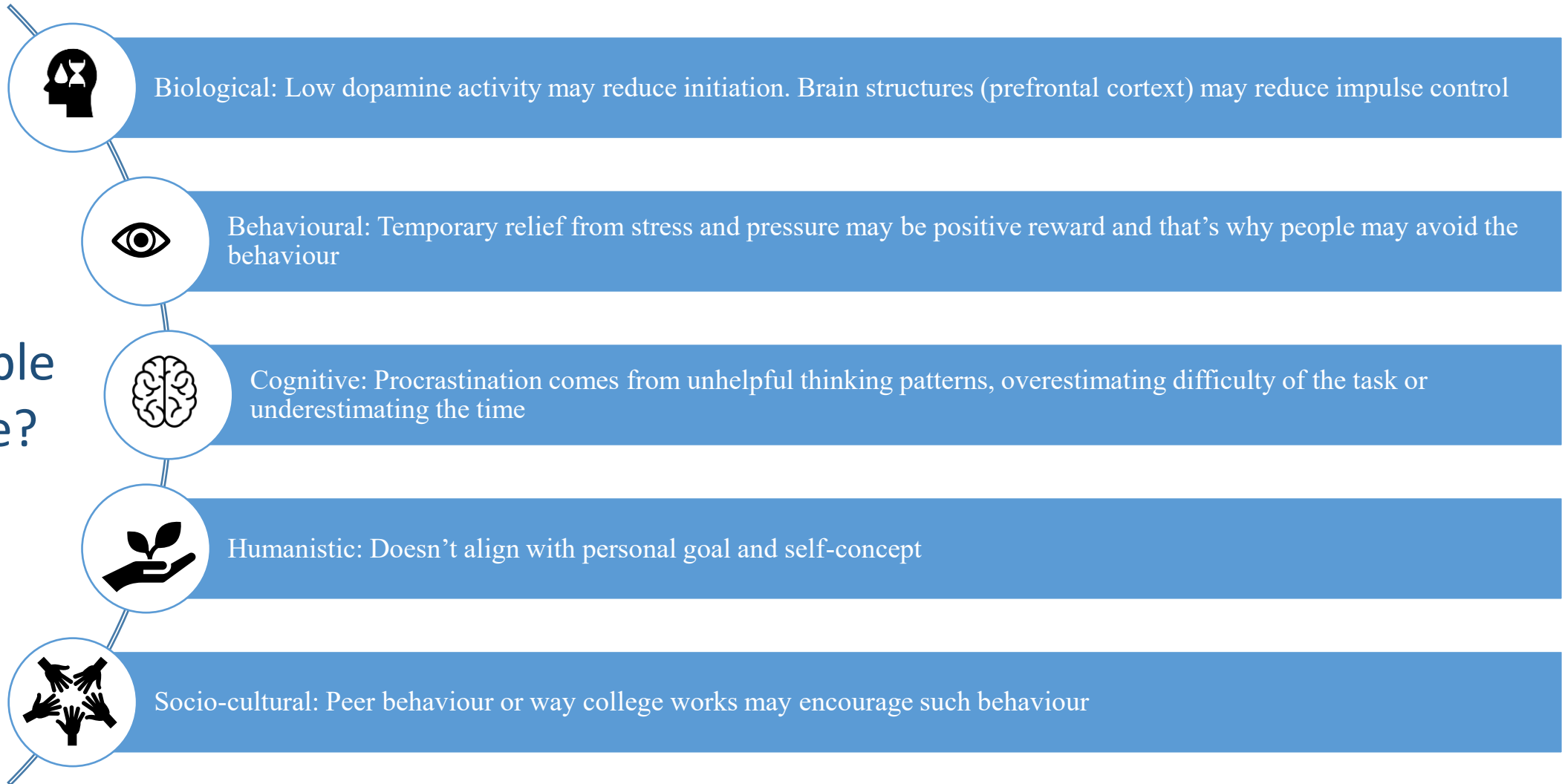
- Structuralism: Wilhelm Wundt aka **Father of Psychology**
- Application of scientific principles to the study of human mind: “What is the structure of the mind?”
- *Introspection:*
 - *Observe their experiences*
 - *Describe sensations precisely (intensity/ quality/ duration)*
 - *Avoid interpretation or meaning making*
- *Laboratory based study!*

- F: Father of Psychology
- A: Analytical introspection
- T: Trained first Psychology students
- H: Helped establish Psychology as science
- E: Established lab at Leipzig, Germany (1879)
- R: Research on Consciousness (Sensations, Images, Feelings)

Timeline of psychology approaches



Why do people procrastinate?



Activity

Why do people get addicted to their phones?

Conclusion

- Father of Psychology: Wilhem Wundt (Structuralism)
- **Approaches:**
 - Biological: dopamine, reward pathway, prefrontal cortex
 - Behavioral: reinforcement, habit learning, cues
 - Humanistic: needs, meaning, self-growth
 - Cognitive: beliefs, attention, interpretation
 - Sociocultural: norms, peer influence, family context